Comparing apples with apples

Variation describes the differences found in **individuals** of a species. Apples are all members of the same species: *Malus domestica*. However, they are not all the same. Look at the following apples and their **characteristics**.

Red Delicious	Pink Lady	Yellow Delicious	Granny Smith
• dark red skin • sweet flavour • five bumps on base • creamy white flesh	• pink and yellow skin • sweet flavour • crisp white flesh	• yellow skin • sweet juicy flavour	• green skin • tart flavour • large firm fruit

☞ **1** Which characteristics vary from one another? _____

_____

2 Which apples share a characteristic? _____

_____

3 Look at the differences between members of your class. Collect data detailing these differences in the table below. Add extra characteristics in the blank heading spaces.

Name	**Hair colour**	**Eye colour**	**Height**		

4 Do you think these differences are passed on from our parents, or are they due to how we live our lives? _____

_____

5 Complete the following sentences to understand the difference between **inherited** variation and **environmental** variation.

Word bank

variation characteristics live parents Differences inherited

D_____ in characteristics gained from our p_____ are called i_____ variation. Differences in c_____ due to the way we l_____ are called environmental v_____.

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